

Octopuses show two sleep states. During quiet sleep the animal turns pale and its pupils narrow to slits, while during active sleep the skin flashes colour patterns that are otherwise used for camouflage during the day.

We filmed four animals over several days and measured how strongly they had to be stimulated before they reacted in each state.

References

Medeiros S. et al. Cyclic alternation of quiet and active sleep states. iScience 2021.